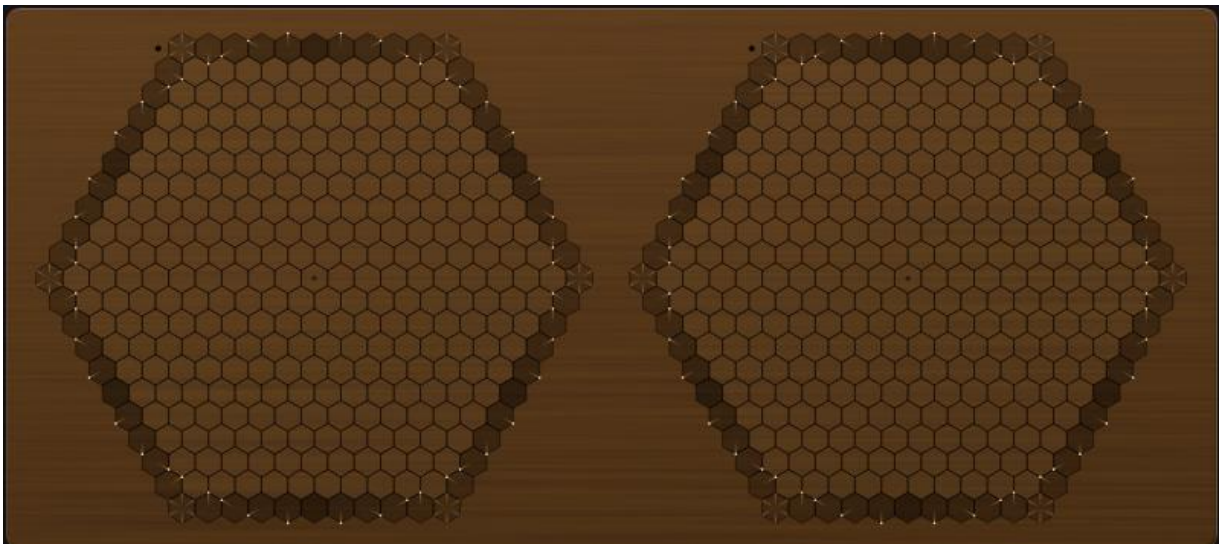
HVEL

2026, Brad Hall, https://www.playhvel.com/rules

Two hex grids, front and back, joined along a shared outer ring to form a seamless globe. There are no edges, a path crossing the ring simply continues on the other grid. The ring has six corner cells, which touch only four neighbors instead of six.



The front face, and the back as seen through the front, so that each ring cell sits in the same spot on both drawings. When placing a stone on a ring cell, place it on both faces relative to the top left dot.

Player 1 opens with 1 stone. Thereafter, play up to 2 stones per turn, or pass.

Play on empty, non-territory cells. If your stone touches any enemy stones, it must have strictly more friendly neighbors than *each* enemy stone it touches.

Enclosures: Complete an unbroken loop of your stones, forming a **wall** around an area:

1. **Capture:** Enclosed enemy stones are removed (unless touching their own territory).
2. **Territory:** Enclosed empty cells that aren't already territory are claimed as your permanent territory.

Goal: Score the most points by claiming territory.

- **Scoring:** Every cell of Territory scores (3 − *c*) points, minimum 0, where *c* is the number of corners inside the loop that claimed it. A corner holding one of that loop's wall stones is not inside it.
- **Game End:** Two consecutive passes. Most points wins (+0.5 pts to the first passer).

Advanced Rules & Clarifications

- **Ring Stones:** A stone on a ring cell is placed on both grids. It's still one stone, not two.
- **The "Smaller Side" Rule:** Any closed loop splits the surface into two sides. Only the **smaller side** counts as enclosed (if both sides are equal, neither is enclosed). The smaller side is the loop's **inside**; a cell is inside a loop if it lies on that side, regardless of what occupies it or what other loops surround it.
- **Wall Stones:** For a given loop, a wall stone must touch the enclosed area and connect two other wall stones of that same loop that don't already touch each other.